PSYCHOLOGICAL/COGNITIVE FALSE BELIEF #32 · DEPRESSION

“Things will never get better.”

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Where it often comes from

When a hard season goes on and on, the mind starts to treat today as a forecast. Illness that does not lift, grief that stays heavy, money that does not ease, or prayers that seem unanswered can teach a person to say, “It will always be like this.” Depression darkens that forecast, so the future looks closed before another day has been lived. The pain can be real. The prediction that nothing can ever improve is still a prediction. If you are thinking about ending your life, call or text 988 in the United States, or tell someone near you right away.

What Scripture teaches

Scripture does not call pain a small thing. It does say that a night of weeping is not the last word. The psalmist said weeping may stay the night, but joy comes in the morning. Looking at ruin, Jeremiah remembered that the Lord’s mercies never fail and are new every morning. These verses do not promise that tomorrow will be easy, or that every loss will be reversed on our timetable. They do say that God is not finished, and that a dark day is not proof the rest of life is dark.

> *“For His anger is fleeting, but His favor lasts a lifetime. Weeping may stay the night, but joy comes in the morning”* (Psalm 30:5).

Also see

> “Because of the loving devotion of the LORD we are not consumed, for His mercies never fail. They are new every morning; great is Your faithfulness!” (Lamentations 3:22–23).

> “He heals the brokenhearted and binds up their wounds” (Psalm 147:3).

> “Do not fear, for I am with you; do not be afraid, for I am your God. I will strengthen you; I will surely help you; I will uphold you with My right hand of righteousness” (Isaiah 41:10).

> “Now may the God of hope fill you with all joy and peace as you believe in Him, so that you may overflow with hope by the power of the Holy Spirit” (Romans 15:13).

Common self-statements

- This is never going to change.
- I have already seen the future, and it is more of the same.
- Good days are over for me.
- If it were going to get better, it would have by now.
- There is no point in looking ahead.
- Other people get relief. I will not.

Common logical errors

- Fortune telling: Deciding the rest of life will be like this hard day.
- Overgeneralization: Turning one long problem into “nothing ever improves.”
- Emotional reasoning: Feeling stuck and treating the feeling as a forecast.
- Discounting the positive: Overlooking any mercy, help, or small change that has already come.

Challenging questions

- What, exactly, do I believe can never change?
- Has a hard season ever shifted later, even a little?
- Am I reading the whole future from how I feel today?
- What help or mercy am I leaving out of the picture?
- What would I tell a friend who said their situation could never improve?
- What is one day I can live without settling the whole future?

Truth summary

> A hard season is not the whole story. God can bring change I cannot see yet, and I can take the next day as it comes.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

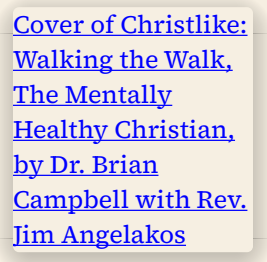
- Hopeless
- Depression, Symptoms of
- Troubles
- Joy
- God, All Loving

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Depression
- Trouble/Hardship
- Thinking, Healthy

What does a mentally healthy Christian look like?



Cover of Christlike: Walking the Walk, The Mentally Healthy Christian, by Dr. Brian Campbell with Rev. Jim Angelakos

From *Christlike: Walking the Walk* by Dr. Brian Campbell. A portrait, verse by verse, of how a mentally healthy Christian thinks, feels, and lives.

Read excerpts from "The Mentally Healthy Christian" (with every Scripture written out)

Listen: Overcoming Depression

Overcoming Depression · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 20 minutes

Listen: Overcoming Anxiety

> Overcoming Anxiety · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 18 minutes

Songs that speak truth to this belief

Praise You in This Storm — Casting Crowns featuring Phil Wickham
You can tell God the truth in a storm without pretending the storm is already over.

Do It Again — Steven Curtis Chapman
God has brought new mercy before, and He can do it again.

Worn — Tenth Avenue North
Weariness can be said out loud while you ask God to restore you.

Because He Lives — Bill and Gloria Gaither
Because Jesus lives, tomorrow is not already ruined.

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, what is one step I could take today?"

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "Things will never get better."

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Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"Things will never get better." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ What, exactly, do I believe can never change?
- ☐ Has a hard season ever shifted later, even a little?
- ☐ Am I reading the whole future from how I feel today?
- ☐ What help or mercy am I leaving out of the picture?
- ☐ What would I tell a friend who said their situation could never improve?
- ☐ What is one day I can live without settling the whole future?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ A hard season is not the whole story. God can bring change I cannot see yet, and I can take the next day as it comes.
- ☐ God can bring change I cannot see yet.
- ☐ Weeping may last the night, and joy can still come.
- ☐ I do not have to solve the whole future today.
- ☐ Mercy has met me before.
- ☐ I can ask for help while I wait.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ Psalm 30:5
  "For His anger is fleeting, but His favor lasts a lifetime. Weeping may stay the night, but joy comes in the morning."
- ☐ Lamentations 3:22–23
  "Because of the loving devotion of the LORD we are not consumed, for His mercies never fail. They are new every morning; great is Your faithfulness!"
- ☐ Psalm 147:3
  "He heals the brokenhearted and binds up their wounds."

A verse I found myself: _____

Practicing the Truth

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5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- [ ] Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- [ ] Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- [ ] Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- [ ] Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- [ ] When the "it will never change" feeling came: Each day, write down one moment when the future felt closed. Write what happened, what you told yourself, and one more accurate statement.
- [ ] My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.

  For example, Psalm 30:5 becomes: "Sarah can write: "This night is hard, and joy can still come in the morning.""
- [ ] Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- [ ] Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- [ ] Reading: The "Hopeless" topic in Pearls.
- [ ] Listening: The Overcoming Depression audio or the Overcoming Anxiety audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

Choose steps you can do safely. If you are thinking about ending your life, call or text 988 (the Suicide & Crisis Lifeline), or call 911 in an emergency. You do not have to carry this alone.

- [ ] Name the forecast. Write the sentence "Things will never get better," then write what you actually know and what you do not know yet.
- [ ] Remember one shift. Write two hard seasons that later eased, even partly. Read them when the forecast feels final.
- [ ] Ask for one practical help. Tell one safe person what feels stuck, and ask for one specific kind of help this week.
- [ ] Get help if the darkness includes wanting to die. If you are thinking about ending your life, call or text 988, or tell someone near you today.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

What I learned: _____

The lie "Things will never get better.": _____ % My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	A moment that was not the whole future
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
Mon		
Tue		
Wed		
Thu		
Fri		
Sat		
Sun		

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~Things will never get better~~

THE TRUTH

GOD'S WORD

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Lord, this season feels endless. Remind me that a hard night is not the end of Your mercy. Help me live this day, and to ask for the help I need. Amen.

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.